

**Managing Army's Human Capital - Innovation, Integration, and Implementation (MAHC-III)
Questions and Answers**

No.	Question(s)	Government Response
1	In Section 7 of the Call for Solution, will the Government please clarify if the Gate Criteria 1 and 2 are excluded from page count and included in the Company Information sheet? The Government does not provide details regarding how Gate Criteria will be verified, making it unclear what information meets the definition of referenceable. Would the Government please revise the instruction to offerors as follows: "For Gate Criteria 1 and Gate Criteria 2, Solution Briefs shall include a one-page data sheet (one page per Gate) that includes: contract numbers, periods of performance, client contact information [name, phone number, and email], and a description of the work. Gate Criteria data sheets do not count toward the 10-page Solution Brief page count allowance."?	Please include Gate Criteria with Company Information using the format below not to exceed 1-2 pages inclusive with Company Information. The format for each program/project reference should include: Program/Project Name: <name, examples: Integrated Personnel and Pay System - Army (IPPS-A)> Organization: <organization name, example: Army PEO Enterprise> Point of Contact: <name, email, phone for PM, COR, or other reference> Brief Description: <Multiple bullets or sentences briefly describing level of expertise applied by your company, example: lead or first time use, actively used or observed use by others, etc.)> A revision to Section 7 - Solution Submission Requirements, has been made in the Call for Solution Amendment 03, which is to be carried over in any additional amendments.
2	Will the Government be using the SSEB, SSAC, SSA for any of the phases of the selection process?	No. Please reference Section E - Awards in the Army Open Solicitation (AOS) Number W9128Z-25-S-A002 that the MAHC-III Call for Solution is posted under.
3	In the evaluation criteria table, the document states the Solution/Alignment with Solution Objectives, "How well does your Solution map to the MAHC-III Objectives? Argue the problem you've chosen is a perfect fit with the problems for this program." Does the Government mean Argue the solution you've chosen is a perfect fit with the problems for this program?	Yes, explain how your solution meets the objectives and solves the problems. An update has been posted in the table in the Call for Solution Amendment 01, which is to be carried over in any additional amendments.
4	Will the Government consider the use of lower than 12-point Arial font for graphics and tables?	We have removed the font requirement and have posted a revision to this section in the Call for Solution Amendment 01, which is to be carried over in any additional amendments. The use of a font and format to present your solution in an effective, high quality manner that is readable without magnification is encouraged.

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5	To thoroughly address the target problem statement and how the proposed solution meets the MAHC-III Objectives in line with the evaluation criteria in Section 10, will the Government please increase the page count to 15 total pages excluding front matter?	No. The written Solution Brief shall not exceed 10 pages for Phase I.
6	PPS-A is the largest global implementation of PeopleSoft Human Capability Management (HCM) and currently operates on infrastructure that will reach end of life in 2027. Given the size of the IPPS-A system, would the Government consider adding a corporate experience requirement to be included in Phase III of the MAHC-III Call for Solution to ensure the Government receives only qualified proposals from proven service providers?	Thank you for inquiry. The requirements for the Phase III submission are still being considered.
7	Section 8 of the Call for Solution identifies an entity as a non-government advisor. Is this the only non-government advisor under the Call for Solution? Will all non-government advisors be prohibited from submitting a response to the Call for Solution based on the potential biased ground rules, unequal access or impaired objectivity OCI restrictions whether actual or perceived? Will any other entities that have provided or are providing the PEO Enterprise technical advice, and/or have provided or are providing program management and technical support services, such as but not limited to requirements review and consultation, attendance at program and/or proposal meetings with only Government and other non-government advisors, participation in meetings, reviews, deliberations and other communications that are inherently internal to the Government be excluded from consideration or otherwise prohibited from participating in a	Thank you for your inquiry. The only non-government advisors for the MAHC-III Call for Solutions are staff providing support to the IPPS-A PMO through Chenega MIOS - Cyberstar, LLC. In accordance with paragraph 9 of the Call for Solutions, Offerors submitting a Solution Brief are required to perform an organizational conflict of interest (OCI) analysis and submit results with their Solution Brief. Any actual or potential OCIs shall be identified to KO/AO prior to award.

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	proposal response or to the Call for Solution based on the potential biased ground rules, unequal access or impaired objectivity OCI restrictions whether actual or perceived?	
8	• What is the primary platform for this solicitation? Will it be posted or updated on any additional sites besides SAM.gov, or is SAM.gov the official and only location for updates and submissions? • Regarding the initial RFI response due June 27, should all responses be submitted through SAM.gov, or is there a designated alternate method or point of contact for submission?	See the MAHC-III Call for Solution Section 5, Solicitation Notes. The primary platform for this solicitation is and will remain SAM.gov. This is the official and only location for updates and submissions. RFI responses should be emailed to the Agreements Officer and Specialist (POCs) listed in the Call for Solution. A revision to Section 7 - Solution Submission Requirements, has been made in the Call for Solution Amendment 03, which is to be carried over in any additional amendments.
9	Section 10 Evaluation Criteria provides this gate criterion: "Submission includes at least one referenceable program/project demonstrating experience implementing and maintaining a PeopleSoft Human Capital Management (HCM) solution supporting at least 10,000 users." Our assumption is that the Government is referring to a "production" HCM solution supporting at least 10,000 users, can you please confirm? Will the Government reconsider Gate 2 (experience implementing and maintaining a PeopleSoft HCM solution supporting at least 10,000 users) as a pass-fail threshold?	Thank you for your inquiry and rationale for consideration. The gate criteria threshold of 10,000 users is the lowest level acceptable. The Government established the gate criteria based on its market research of large PeopleSoft customers and implementations. Supporting over 1.1M Soldiers as self-service users and over 40,000 human resources professionals, IPPS-A is the largest global implementation of PeopleSoft Human Capability Management (HCM). The Government requires PeopleSoft expertise to maintain, expand, and continuously improve the current software baseline. The gate criteria is not exclusive to DoD-experienced integrators to access the broadest pool of qualified vendors and innovation.
10	Will the Government allow a Compliance Matrix to be submitted outside the page count?	If a company would like to submit a Compliance Matrix, it will be counted towards the overall page limit.
11	Will the Government allow 8.5 x 11 page landscape graphics within the Call for Solution response?	The Government will allow 8.5 x 11 page landscape graphics within the overall page count. A revision to Section 7 - Solution Submission Requirements, has been made in the Call for Solution Amendment 03, which is to be carried over in any additional amendments.

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12	Could the Government please provide the name of the incumbent contractor currently performing the IPPS-A Capability Support services that the MAHC III effort is intended to succeed?	As stated in the IPPS-A Training, Deployment, Sustainment (TDS) System Integration and Solution Delivery (SI&SD) INC II notice on SAM.gov, CACI Inc.-Federal, Chantilly, Virginia, was awarded the current contract for IPPS-A capabilities support. For more information, see https://sam.gov/opp/aea2daab193644e3acd8dc296f3fb985/view
13	To help industry assess the magnitude and scope of the MAHC III requirement, could the Government provide an estimated total contract value or funding range anticipated for the full seven-year period of performance (base plus options)?	The estimated total contract value and duration will be determined as a result of using the Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) process as outlined in the MAHC-III Call for Solutions. For reference, the IPPS-A TDS INC II notice covered an award for a one year period of similar scope. The Government is seeking innovative solutions to gain efficiencies and cost savings to manage a similar scope. For more information, see https://sam.gov/opp/aea2daab193644e3acd8dc296f3fb985/view .
14	The SOO indicates an anticipated contract award in Q4FY25. Could the Government provide more detail on the planned acquisition timeline, specifically the anticipated date or timeframe for the formal Request for Proposal (RFP) release for the MAHC III effort? Will you be sending the recording out from the recent Industry Day event?	The timeline for the MAHC-III Call for Solutions was reviewed during Industry Day and slides are available at: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Kc4whhN0x9w . As outlined in section 7 of the Call for Solutions, Solutions Proposals will be requested during phase 3. Following phase 3, an award is anticipated in Q1FY26.
15	The Bridge PWS requires the contractor to estimate staffing for core execution and surge size. Could the Government please provide an estimate of the total number of full-time equivalent (FTE) personnel anticipated to be required to perform the entire scope of work under the MAHC III contract?	The Bridge PWS was provided as a reference for how the scope of work has been structured and managed in the past. The Government is seeking innovative solutions to gain efficiencies and cost savings to manage a similar scope for delivering integrated personnel and pay capabilities for 1.1M Soldiers using PeopleSoft products. The Government seeks solutions with innovative processes, tools, and technologies that can offset the need to surge the number of instructors and support personnel to accommodate spikes in training, deployment, and post-deployment support.

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16	Could the Government clarify the planned relationship between the IPPS-A Capability Support Bridge Contract (referenced in the RFI and PWS) and the MAHC III acquisition? Specifically, is MAHC III intended to be the direct follow-on to the bridge contract, covering a similar or expanded scope?	The Government has planned for a 6 month overlap with the Bridge contract to enable knowledge transfer for managing the largest global implementation of PeopleSoft Human Capital Management (HCM). Following the 6 month overlap, the Bridge contract will expire, and the scope of work will be performed under the selected MAHC-III solution. The Government is seeking innovative solutions to gain efficiencies, manage a similar scope, and complete knowledge transfer effectively in 6 months or less.
17	The Bridge PWS indicates required temporary travel to CONUS and OCONUS locations where the number of trips is unknown. Could the Government provide any historical data or current estimates regarding the anticipated frequency, duration, and common destinations for required contractor travel under the MAHC III contract?	The Bridge PWS was provided as a reference for how the scope of work has been structured and managed in the past. Historically, IPPS-A staff (Government and contractors) have traveled to support deployment of capability to 1.1M Soldiers including approximately 46,000 human resources (HR) professionals managed predominantly by the Army's Human Resources Command (see https://www.hrc.army.mil/). In the future, IPPS-A will need to train Army Military Pay (AMP) professionals located at approximately 60 pay offices. The Government seeks solutions to include a training strategy with innovative processes, tools, and technologies that can offset the need to travel to accommodate spikes in training, deployment, and post-deployment support.
18	Will the Government provide a sanitized Soldier record example?	Thank you for your question. The Government will provide a representative, synthetic Soldier record from the IPPS-A training environment to the Bidder's Library. Continue to watch SAM.gov for this information.
19	Understanding that questions, feedback or comments need to be submitted as requested by Tuesday, June 10th, we'd like to confirm the deadlines as no time is specified in any of the Call for Solution documents: • The Call for Solution Rev 02 document (page 5) states: "The deadline to submit questions for Phase I is 10 June 2025" • The Call for Solution Rev 02 document (page 1) states: "**Solution Briefs Due Date/Time (Suspense): 27 June 2025." Can you please provide the time	These are the correct dates. The window for question submissions has closed. White paper solution submissions are due by 1700 EDT on the stated date of 27 June 2025. The Call for Solution Amendment 03 Cover Page has been updated with this information.

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	vendors shall submit Questions and the Solution Brief by?	
20	Regarding the place of performance for this opportunity, do both the prime and subcontractors need to hold a clearance? If so, could you please confirm the required level of clearance?	Anticipated clearance requirements will require the Prime vendor to have a Secret facility clearance. Further details will be provided in the DD254 during Phase III of the Call for Solution methodology.
21	Can you confirm if it is the Army's intent to select and award ONE (1) primary vendor to "effectively operate and maintain the integrated Army HR and payroll software solution and develop new and enhanced HR software capabilities"?	As outlined in the Call for Solutions, "The IPPS-A Inc II program is seeking a single, comprehensive solution to effectively operate and maintain the integrated Army Human Resources (HR) and payroll software solution and continue development of new and enhanced HR software capabilities." The preference is to award to a single solution and the contracting strategy is pending the outcome of what is learned from the Call for Solutions. The final determination will be made during Phase III.
22	Question 1; Has a software test automation and / or robotic process automation tool been selected? If not, is an evaluation for a software test automation and / or robotic process automation tool still ongoing? Not started? Is so, what is the best to engage the program office in a discussion regarding AI-assisted software test automation? Question 2: Is there any additional functionality in planning for future implementation or that is not already shown on Slide #21?	A test automation tool has not been selected, at this point. The Call for Solution contains a list of software current as of 9 May 2025. The program is using an agile methodology, and the software list is subject to change.
23	Attachment A: MAHC-III SOO Section 3 Period of Performance/Place of Performance states that, "IPPS-A requests Industry propose a modular schedule that supports requirements through 2032 or the delivery of AMP plus a stabilization period." Please confirm that the Government is not requesting a schedule for the Phase 1 white paper/solution brief.	There is no requirement for a schedule to be provided in the white paper solution submission.

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24	Section 10 Evaluation Criteria provides this gate criterion: "Submission includes at least one referenceable program/project demonstrating experience implementing and maintaining a PeopleSoft Human Capital Management (HCM) solution supporting at least 10,000 users." PeopleSoft sizing guidelines typically include both user count (reflecting the scale of system usage) and payroll employee count (reflecting the scale and complexity of frequent internal processing operations). Request the Government specify payroll employee count in addition to user count to allow this gate criterion to demonstrate scale and complexity more similar to IPPS-A. Oracle characterizes an Extra Large configuration as 500,000 payroll employees.	The Government is firm with the gate criteria as described in the Call for Solution
25	Would the Government consider augmenting the Section 10 Evaluation Criteria to include one referenceable program/project "for demonstrating experience implementing and maintaining a PeopleSoft Human Capital Management (HCM) solution across unclassified and classified environments in light of the 4.1 Solution Objective associated with maintaining the integrity of the IPPS-A baseline across all environments inclusive of NIPRNET and SIPRNET?"	The Government is firm with the evaluation criteria as described in the Call for Solution
26	How many vendors does the Government intend to down select for the live pitch (if required)?	The number of vendors is undetermined at this time. Invitations to participate in the Phase II Pitch Sessions will be determined based on the evaluation of the Solution Briefs.
27	Can the Government please provide the list of 20 legacy systems that will be subsumed?	The Government will provide the list of 20 legacy systems in the Bidder's Library. Continue to watch SAM.gov for this information.
28	Can the Government please clarify what level of detail is required in the Pricing Model Evaluation since no pricing is being submitted? Does the Army want to hear about each company's revenue model to support best value approaches?	Request vendors provide information on their revenue model and how the model balances profitability, affordability, and incentives so that the Government gets the best value.

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29	What is the scope and touch points between the Cloud Migration task order and the HCM Contract (this contract)?	Oracle is under contract for the Cloud Migration (See article from DEC 2024 https://executivegov.com/2024/12/army-personnel-pay-system-launch-oracle-cloud/). The MACH-III solution requirements include support for re-factoring of baseline code, configuration, and testing to ensure ongoing operation of the baseline system as the platform migration is completed.
30	What are the current COOP/Disaster Recovery requirements? (Cold, Warm, Hot)	IPPS-A currently operates in two on-premise data centers with a primary environment and a secondary failover environment inclusive of production instances on NIPRNet and SIPRNet connected via a cross domain solution. Both the primary and secondary data centers support several development, testing, and training environments as depicted on slide 22 of 34 from Industry Day #2 (see https://www.eis.army.mil/sites/default/files/2025-06/MAHC-III%20Industry%20Day%205%20JUN%202025.pdf). IPPS-A operates the secondary environment as a warm stand-by to support failover operations.
31	What is the PeopleSoft HCM image version?	PeopleSoft HCM 9.2 PUM 49
32	What is the current PeopleTools version?	PeopleTools 8.60.11
33	What is the PeopleSoft HCM modules that have been implemented?	IPPS-A has implemented the following PeopleSoft HCM modules: core Human Resources (HR), Talent Management, Profile Management, Workforce Administration, and Benefits. IPPS-A is currently implementing the Global Payroll and Financial Management modules. Separately, IPPS-A has implemented PeopleSoft Customer Relationship Management (CRM) for the IPPS-A Help Desk and Enterprise Learning Management (ELM) for IPPS-A Training.
34	How many environments?	IPPS-A currently operates several on-premise environments on NIPRNet and SIPRNet to support production, development, testing, and training. For a representation of the environments, please refer to slide 22 of 34 from Industry Day #2 (see https://www.eis.army.mil/sites/default/files/2025-06/MAHC-III%20Industry%20Day%205%20JUN%202025.pdf).

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35	How many PeopleSoft databases are there – is it a single database for HCM and Payroll or a separate for HCM & Payroll?	IPPS-A is a single, integrated system with databases in production for Human Capital Management (HCM), Customer Relationship Management (CRM), Enterprise Learning Management (ELM), Business Intelligence (OBIEE), Data Quality (DQP), and Financial Management (FMDB). Databases will for Global Payroll and a second HCM instance for retirees will be added as future capabilities are released and deployed.
36	In SOO Attachment C - IPPS-A Operating Model by Function, it is mentioned that "Implement PeopleSoft Global Payroll". What is the current payroll system used for processing employee pay?	Army Military Pay is currently processed through the Defense Joint Military Pay System (DJMS) operated by the Defense Finance Accounting Service (DFAS). Two instances of DJMS are utilized by the U.S. Army; one for Active Component Soldiers and one for Reserve Component Soldiers. As depicted in Attachment C, another vendor is responsible for development and configuration of Global Payroll to replace the capabilities in DJMS. Migration into the IPPS-A baseline, regression testing, and release management falls within the scope of the MAHC-III solution requirements.
37	Col Paul mentioned low code/no code and eventually AI. What does this mean to the PS solution already fielded and in use? Please clarify.	The Government is seeking innovative ways to apply tools and technologies that complement and leverage the PeopleSoft foundation. The objective is to accelerate and provide flexible, secure methods to meet requirements by the community without adding customizations.
38	One must assume that Small Businesses are excluded as prime contractors given the requirement for over 10k users...please clarify.	The gate criteria emphasizes critical requirements that must be met to reduce risk to the program. All offerors (small or large businesses or teams) submitting Solution Briefs who meet the requirements will be considered.
39	Are you intending to award a single vendor or is this expected to result in multiple vendor awards?	Please refer to the same answer in Question #21.
40	Will the 17 October award be for a FAR based contract, OTA or something else?	The contracting strategy is pending the outcome of what is learned from the Call for Solutions and will be finalized during Phase III.
41	Is Oracle already under contract for the transition/re-platforming effort?	Please refer to the same answer in Question #29, referencing Cloud Migration.